

Ian Sidman

Viral & Growth Marketer

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Professional Summary

Growth Marketer with expertise in managing social media accounts and early-stage startup growth. My work has generated 300M organic shortform views and has built me a personal following of 60,000 on TikTok. With short-form content I've grown 23K followers in 7 days and then using that same skill set I've launched my own businesses.

Recently I grew PiñataFarms AI 70,000 users through content. My best short-form video for them produced \$16,000 in revenue.

I am experienced in AI, startups, identifying opportunities to capture markets, execution, and people.

My work ethic is intense and goal-oriented (including achieving the USA bench press national record). I thrive in fast-paced environments with important problems to solve.

Willing to relocate: Anywhere

Work Experience

Founder Viral Builders-Hawthorne, CA May 2026 to Present
(Full-Time, On-Site)

Viral Builders is an independent venture building and shipping mobile apps.

- Published 4 mobile apps to the App Store
- Leveraged AI to speed up coding, learning, & outcomes
- Learned Facebook Ads to drive installs
- Focused on [CarbLens AI](#) which turns diabetes management into a fun game you can play with your friends. It also supports users with AI. 300 installs and 21 paying users

Growth Intern Piñata Farms AI- Culver City, CA December 2025 to May 2026
(Full-Time)

Pinata Farms is an AI Consumer App that makes funny AI Videos.

This was a performance marketing role where I managed their social media presence across tiktok, instagram, youtube, and reddit. I was also responsible for tracking with app store connect, cold

outreach, influencer relationships, and accurately reporting organic marketing to the CEO & in a way the rest of the company could understand.

- Saw an emerging trend on [TikTok](#), quickly pushed to the team to enable our users to make their own pranks. Started pushing it on TikTok by ranking #1 on TikTok organic/search. 6,000 users in 3 days of release. 17,000 users in the first month via TikTok.
- Built an organic strategy across TikTok & Reddit from zero on TikTok to 350 million views and 70,000 users across IOS & Android.
- Got creators such as [hammy.tv](#) (30 million followers) & several others to promote our app for free or on a paid basis.
- Fully mapped out our organic marketing funnel to identify & remove constraints.
- Built & killed many vanity metrics because they didn't lead to revenue (including 30 million views a month with a certain angle that didn't convert, and multiple teams in the NFL, NBA, and NHL using our sounds)

Organizer Charity Karaoke- Agoura Hills, CA August 2024 to Present
(Seasonal)

Charity Karaoke is a seasonal karaoke competition where 20 local charities compete to raise money for their causes.

I am responsible for managing their social media presence and improving event attendance.

- Improved Attendance 2x Years In A Row
- Directed a team of creators, filmmakers, and actors to produce short-form content for the event
- Increase donations 25% & followers 976% through shareable social media content.
- Collaborated & built relationships with local business owners and influencers to promote the event.
- Raised \$94,000 total

Content Hype Ventures-Simi Valley, CA December 2023 to Dec 2025
(Part-Time)

Hype ventures is a consumer products studio focused on creating and marketing viral products with over 1 billion views across all of their products.

I have been involved in doing various tasks for them as needed over the years.

- Lead shortform content strategy for a new product
- Helped ship orders, move and setup equipment, organize, and fix broken products
- Was offered content manager role

Tons of amazing learning from a company that's crushing it. (founder is a mentor)

My time here was a gift

Founder SocialLab-Thousand Oaks, CA January 2022 to December 2025

(Part-Time)

A consulting company where I worked with various personal brands, nonprofits, and businesses to help them get results with shortform content

- Worked with several accounts between 0-1.2M followers
- 50 million view marketing angle for a client.
- Launched 2 ecom stores, achieved 9% conversion rate on one.
- Able to get visible results for multiple businesses after one strategy call. (over 100k views)
- Built MVP & team of 7 in college to create AI for viral videos (killed & pivoted)

Social Media Manager Conejo Awards-Westlake Village, CA June 2024 to August 2025

(Part-Time)

Conejo Awards is a one stop shop for businesses to print custom products, awards, or anything they need.

- Learned the brand and created shortform content that fit brand goals/identity.
- Filmed, edited, coordinated, and posted shortform content.
- Created a series that brought in ~150,000 shortform views monthly

Business Owner Goofy Garments-Eugene, OR December 2022 to April 2023

(Full-Time)

A clothing brand I started out of my college dorm

- Realized there was unmet demand and created the brand that was missing
- Built my own shopify website and got 2,500,000 shortform views on Instagram in 2 weeks.
- Scaled to \$4,000 a month profit in only 3 months via viral instagram content
- Kept customers engaged with creative community engagement
- 5,800,000 views, 282,000 shares, 193 new customers, & \$5,000 in sales from one short form video
- 1,100 unique customers total.

Content Creator

TikTok-Thousand Oaks, CA

December 2020 to December 2021

(Part-Time)

A 60,000 follower personal blog where I posted about diabetes, health, fitness, and funny/relatable skits.

- Watched for trends & critiqued my content strategy until I found what worked.
- Learned from my own posting data diabetes related content reached the most viewers.
- Combined an existing trend, with a viral topic (diabetes), and started a new trend of people 'quitting' their incurable illnesses (100 million views).
- Gained 9,300,000 views & 23,200 followers in 7 days after finding the signal.
- Studied what people were watching & came up with multiple series that consistently got 100k-5M views.
- Got sponsored by Dexcom after getting their products over 8 million views.
- Accepted a few brand deals
- 35 million views total

Retail Sales

Marshalls-Thousand Oaks, CA

January 2021 to May 2021

(Part-Time)

Marshalls is a retail store that sells clothing and lifestyle products.

- Handled customer complaints, needs, and returns.
- Maintained cleaning standards during covid
- Rang up customers and upsold Marshalls credit cards
- Labeled, organized, and sorted inventory
- Set up displays for products
- Counted and documented incoming customers, handled suspicious customers
- Created an energetic and fun work environment for customers & employees

Other Experiences

Sleep In Heavenly Peace:

Helped direct bed building events, volunteered time, ran socials, created beds for kids that sleep on the floor.

Harbor House:

helped with their marketing, launched a youtube series to promote their services.

Calvary Community Church:

Community engagement & served multiple times.

Euka AI:

Recently hired to fix their socials, left because it wasn't a fit.

Education

Business Administration (College)

University of Oregon-Eugene, OR

August 2023 to June 2024

Currently taking a break

High school diploma

Westlake High School-Westlake Village, CA August 2018 to June 2022

Skills

- Content creation (14 years)
- Brand storytelling (4 years)
- Viral marketing (5 years)
- Go-to-market strategy (5 years)
- Consumer behaviour (5 years)
- Marketing analytics (2 years)
- Go-to-market strategy (5 years)
- Attention science (6 years)
- Leadership (4 years)
- E-commerce (7 years)
- AI (3 Years)
- Video editing (3-5 years)
- Swift/Mobile Apps (1 year)

Links

<http://iansidman.com>

<https://iansidman.com/portfolio>

<https://www.linkedin.com/in/ian-sidman/>

Awards

United States Bench Press National Record

September 2021

United States national record for benching 336lbs at age 17

California Bench Press State Record

September 2021

California state record for benching 336lbs at age 17

California Squat State Record

September 2021

California state record in for squatting 446lbs at age 17

Certifications and Licenses

Harvard CS50 (90% Completion)

Used to communicate to my co-founder about the technical side of SocialLab.

Google OKR Certification: Leadership And Goal Setting

Used to inspire strategy to lead my startup

Reid Hoffman and Chris Yeh on Blitzscaling

Additional Information

References:

Noah Gale Founder of Tribe.AI (contact for info)

Ezra Uzayr Founder of Hype Ventures (contact for info)

Carlos Adams Founder of Piñata Farms AI (contact for info)

Impressive Accomplishments:

- Got the USA bench press national record and squat state record at age 17
- 300m+ views between brands, startups, and trends I've started
- Identified and launched a feature at PiñataFarms AI that I grew to 70,000 users through organic
- Built a clothing brand from my college dorm to \$4,000 a month profit in 3 months
- Took 11 brands past 100k views on organic for their first time
- TikTok creator with 60k followers, gained 23k in a week. Achieved similar multiple times.

Tools:

Claude Code, Claude, GitHub, Vercel, Instantly AI, GoHighLevel, Shopify, App Store Connect, Adobe Photoshop, Adobe Premiere Pro, Notion, Slack, Full Google Suite, After Effects, Figma, CapCut, Wix, Braze, ChatGPT, Sora AI, Audacity, DALL-E Ai, Canva, OBS, Notion, Microsoft Word, Microsoft Excel, Microsoft Powerpoint, Power Automate, Cursor, Visual Studio Code, XCode, Discord, Beehiv, Substack, Instagram, Meta Ads, Tiktok, Tiktok Ads, Youtube, Linkedin, Lucidspark, Printify, Alibaba, Coinbase.

And a ton more, I learn and pick up new tools really fast.

More Skills/Hobbies:

AI use and integration into workflows, prompt engineering, email marketing, website building, funnel building/mapping/constraint removal, conversion rate optimization, click rate optimization, storytelling, videography, creative marketing, social engineering (irl marketing), basic coding, AI/vibe coding, networking, people skills, organizing, creativity, communication skills, advanced computer and phone use, AI video generation, AI image generation, PC building, and hardware optimization, basic physical construction